

Lee Enfield rifle
The standard infantry weapon was the Short Magazine Lee Enfield (SMLE) bolt-action rifle. The model shown here, the Mark III star, was the one issued to most British soldiers on the Western Front, where it proved a reliable and accurate weapon.

.303 ammunition
Rounds of this calibre were adopted by the British army for rifles and machine-guns in 1889.

Rifle with wire-cutting attachment
This combination weapon and tool, designed for infantry advancing to take an enemy trench, was used with the bayonet fixed. The wire was supposed to run down the blade into the jaws of the wire cutters. Like many inventions of World War I, it was not as successful as had first been hoped.

Stokes mortar bomb
The mortar was little more than a 7.6cm (3in) smooth-bored metal tube with a firing pin in the base. When the bomb was dropped down the barrel, a cartridge in its tail struck the firing pin and exploded, launching the bomb. Although the bomb turned end-over-end as it flew, it was an effective means of lobbing high-explosive into the enemy trenches.

Trench clubs
In hand-to-hand fighting in a narrow trench, the rifle and bayonet often proved unwieldy, especially at night. Soldiers on night raids favoured smaller, cruder weapons such as knives or home-made nailed clubs